

Michael Kotrous

Ph.D. Candidate
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University of Georgia

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Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Georgia, 2021–Present (expected August 2027)
M.A. Economics, University of Georgia, 2023
B.A. Economics and Journalism (*summa cum laude*), Creighton University, 2015

Research Fields and Interests

Industrial organization, labor economics; franchising, broadband

Job Market Paper

[1] “The Effect of Municipal Broadband on Labor Markets: Evidence from Chattanooga, TN”

Refereed Journal Articles

[2] “Broadband Speeds in Fibered U.S. Markets: An Empirical Analysis” with James Bailey, 2021, **Journal of Information Policy** 11: 478–522
[3] “The Benefits of Coronavirus Suppression: A Cost-Benefit Analysis of the Response to the First Wave of COVID-19 in the United States” with James Broughel, 2021, **PLOS ONE** 16(6): e0252729

Works in Progress

[4] “The Labor Market Effects of No-Poach Clauses in the Quick-Service Restaurant Industry”
[5] “Multi-Unit Ownership in U.S. Fast Food Franchising” with Peter Newberry

Conference and Seminar Presentations

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting (2025, 2024, 2015)
TPRC Research Conference on Communications, Information and Internet Policy (2021)
Rural Digital Divide Roundtable, Nebraska College of Law (2020)
Future of Work Conference, Mercatus Center and Niskanen Center (2019)
Graduate School 101 Seminar, Institute for Humane Studies (2016)
Economics Scholars Program Conference, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas (2015)

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Swift Undergraduate Teaching Fellowship, Department of Economics, University of Georgia, 2025
Outstanding TA Award, Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Georgia, 2025
Graduate School Domestic Travel Grants, University of Georgia, 2024 and 2025
Bastiat Fellowship, Mercatus Center at George Mason University, 2021–2022
Carl Menger Essay Award, Society for the Development of Austrian Economics, 2015
Omicron Delta Epsilon, Creighton University, 2015
Gail Werner-Robertson Fellowship, Creighton University, 2014–2015

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

Intermediate Macroeconomics, University of Georgia	Fa 2026
Sports Economics, University of Georgia	Fa 2026
Survey of Economics (online, asynchronous), Coastal Carolina University	Fa 2026
Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Georgia	Su 2024

Teaching Assistant, University of Georgia

Macroeconomic Theory (Ph.D.), Recitation Leader and Grader	Fa 2022–Sp 2026
Economic Analysis for Business Leaders (M.B.A.), Grader	Fa 2023
Senior Thesis (Undergraduate), Grader and Student Support	Sp 2022
Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate Honors), Grader	Fa 2021–Sp 2022

Research and Professional Experience

Economics and Finance Quality Control Auditor, Scale AI, San Francisco, CA, 2025–Present
Summer Research Assistant for Peter Newberry, University of Georgia, Athens, GA, 2023–2025
Analyst, JPinkse LLC, State College, PA, 2023–2024
Program Manager, Mercatus Center at George Mason University, Arlington, VA, 2016–2021
Interactive Web Developer, Swanson Russell, Lincoln, NE, 2013–2016

Selected Policy Publications and Commentary

- [1] “Rural Broadband Deployment in Florida: Recommendations for Reform” with Brent Skorup, *The Journal of the James Madison Institute* 64, Fall 2021
- [2] “Narrowing the Rural Digital Divide with Consumer Vouchers” with Brent Skorup, Mercatus Center Policy Brief, Oct. 2020
- [3] “Why Economists Measure Human Lives in Dollars” with James Broughel, *POLITICO*, Apr. 2020
- [4] “Quantifying Regulation in U.S. States” with James Broughel and Patrick McLaughlin, Mercatus Center Data Visualization, Nov. 2019

Professional Service

Referee Activity

Center for Growth and Opportunity at Utah State University

Conference Discussant

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting (2025, 2024)
Western Economic Association International (WEAI) Virtual International Conference (2021)

Selected Workshops and Professional Development

Tools for Macroeconomics: Essentials, London School of Economics (2022)
Summer Empirical Workshop, Center for Free Enterprise, West Virginia University (2016)
Advanced Austrian Seminar, Mercatus Center at George Mason University (2016)

Technical Skills

MATLAB, Python, R, Stata

References

Peter Newberry (chair)
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
University of Georgia
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Meghan Skira
Sara and Dan Boyd Professor
Department of Economics
University of Georgia
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Jeff Thurk
Principal Economist
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Roozbeh Hosseini (teaching reference)
Associate Professor
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